Deep Dive Strategy Presentation

SuperK-Taxi Korea

Earn the right to be Korea’s strong #2.
Start with reliable, licensed taxi supply in Seoul.

August 2024 launch • H2 execution

Decision requested: approve two Seoul beachheads and an initial ₩2bn tranche; reserve the remaining ₩6bn against explicit service and economic gates.

THE STRATEGIC CHOICE

01 Win peak-hour supply

02 Fix Korean journeys

03 Scale only what works

Win local reliability before buying national reach

Rebranded challenger; current share, active supply and monetization are unverified. Establish a May–July baseline before scaling.

≈90%+

Kakao T app-call dominance

Historical 2021 estimate, cited in KFTC's 2023 dispatch case—not current share. [1]

₩4,800

Seoul standard base fare

From ₩3,800 in February 2023 (+26%): reliability must justify a higher trip cost. [5]

11.03m

International arrivals in 2023

63% of 2019's 17.50m: an accessible recovery segment, not the whole strategy. [4]

Why a national promotion blitz fails

- Kakao's demand density and habitual usage pull drivers back; Tada and i.M also contest differentiated rides.
- Licensed fleet size is not usable supply: vacant corporate shifts, multi-homing and empty repositioning constrain availability. [2,3,7]
- A rebrand cannot cure failed matches, Korean address friction or weak driver earnings.

Where we can create a wedge

- Concentrate on two Seoul clusters and selected peak windows; win the full pickup experience, not app installs.
- Sell repeatability to commuters and businesses; use hotels and visitors as an acquisition wedge.
- Make fair dispatch and driver net earnings measurable. Enforcement against an incumbent is not a growth plan. [1]

Ambition: #2 rider-app MAU by end-2025; H2 proof: dependable pickups + retained riders + a credible path to contribution.

[1,4,5] Historical public data; not May 2024 market shares. [2,3,7] Supply context. Evidence and limits: appendices A–B.

Pay for productive peak shifts—not registered cars

Accountable owner: Korea Operations GM. Launch two clusters in August; add the next two only after four weeks of service quality.

A dense Seoul beachhead

AUGUST / Gangnam–Yeoksam + Jongno–Jung

Office, hotel, station and hospital pickup microzones; start 07:00–10:00 and 18:00–02:00. Refine using demand logs.

OCTOBER GATE / Yeouido + Hongdae–Mapo

Expand only if adjacent-cell supply is not cannibalized. Airport pre-booking is a separate, permission-led pilot.

- Corporate fleets: recruit into idle licensed shifts with fleet managers; help onboarding and rosters—not speculative vehicle purchases.
- Independent taxis: local driver-association roadshows, referrals paid after 20 completed trips, Korean onboarding within 48 hours.
- Create a driver council; keep multi-homing, publish net ₩/online hour and fix earnings or payout complaints weekly.

The supply operating system

01 / Recruit & verify

Check licensed taxi, driver qualification and insurance; one verified driver account per active shift. [3,6]

02 / Activate the right hours

Geo/time-limited top-ups, capped at ₩20k per eligible shift; pay only incremental availability and completed service.

03 / Retain productive supply

Fast local support and clear payouts; taper top-ups ₩20k → ₩10k → zero by cohort as organic trips / hour rise.

04 / Dispatch without favoritism

Audit franchise-neutral matching; explain acceptance rules and monitor destination-based refusals and cancellations. [1]

December targets: +3,000 weekly active drivers | ≥85% match rate | ≤8 min P90 request-to-pickup | ≥65% 4-week driver retention

[2,3,6,7] Licensed supply and safety framework. All volumes, service levels and incentive amounts below are proposed targets.

Turn a first reliable ride into a Korean habit

Accountable owners: Head of Product + Head of Growth. Allocate ₩1.2bn to tracked, cell-specific activation—not broad awareness.

REPEAT LOCAL RIDERS

Commuters + late-evening users

- Office, station and hospital pickup campaigns only where supply gates are met.
- First-ride referral credit; second-ride reward only after a real completed trip.
- Cap new-rider CAC at ₩6k; target ≥40% unsubsidized repeat within 30 days.

Primary growth engine

BUSINESS ACCOUNTS

Employers + hospitals + hotels

- Sell 100 active pilot accounts by December: receipts, cost centres and monthly billing.
- Pre-book time-critical rides with contracted licensed supply; show honest availability.
- No unconditional pickup guarantee; measure fulfilment and renewal before expansion.

Retention + lawful revenue test

INBOUND VISITORS

Hotel / OTA / airport partners

- Foreign phone and card acceptance; clear pickup gates and bilingual trip support.
- Acquire through hotel desks and partner links; use global accounts only if available.
- Airport offers require approved pickup procedures and separate operating sign-off.

Low-friction demand wedge [4]

Launch-quality product—not a translated interface

- Korean address / POI search, building entrance pins and landmark pickup photos; validate map SDK and POI licensing.
- Korean cards and local wallets; foreign cards / numbers; digital receipts, masked calls and Korean support.
- Show matching status, fare / night-premium estimates, pickup ETA and cancellation terms before confirmation. [5]
- Run 200 moderated local pickup tests before August; ship fixes weekly. Stop campaigns in cells with falling fulfilment.

[4,5] Tourism and fare context. Segment sizes, acquisition costs and retention below are targets, not observed performance.

Make compliance and driver trust launch requirements

Keep the licensed-taxi model. Build a defensible fair marketplace—not a private-car or unapproved pricing workaround.

Licensed capacity & pricing

- Verify Type 3 brokerage registration and taxi contracts. Type 2 franchise expansion needs separate approval. [6]
- Use local meter tariffs. Counsel must approve booking, premium and B2B fees; no default surge on regulated fares. [5,6]
- Sign off city boundaries, airport pickup rules, cancellation terms and settlement flows before launch.

Fair dispatch & safety

- Audit franchise-neutral dispatch; publish matching rules, allow multi-homing and remove branded-supply bias. [1]
- Verify qualification, vehicle and insurance. TS and association rosters establish eligibility—not active availability. [2,3]
- 24/7 Korean incident support, trip sharing, emergency escalation and driver appeals; suspend serious-risk accounts.

Korean data by design

- Map PIPA and location-data duties: lawful basis, notices / consent, retention limits and access controls. [8]
- Review overseas transfers and processors; any global integration depends on a lawful transfer design. [8]
- Minimize location and payment-data exposure. Complete security tests and a breach playbook before August.

August release: three signatures, no exceptions

LEGAL / COMPLIANCE

Permits, tariffs, contracts, airport and data approvals

OPERATIONS / SAFETY

Verified roster, incident desk, driver council and dispatch audit

PRODUCT / SECURITY

Korean journey acceptance, payment and privacy controls

[1,3,5,6,8] Regulatory synthesis, not legal advice. Counsel must confirm the rules and approvals in force before each launch.

Release ₩8bn in stages—not as a national subsidy war

CEO decision: authorize two beachheads and the first ₩2bn. CFO controls further releases; Korea GM owns a weekly service-and-economics review.

Incremental H2 envelope

Supply activation ₩2.4bn top-ups + ₩0.8bn onboarding	**₩3.2bn**
Demand activation Tracked first-trip riders / business sales	**₩1.2bn**
Product + localization Korean UX, dispatch and payments	**₩1.4bn**
Operations + compliance Includes ₩0.6bn variable trip costs	**₩1.2bn**
Contingency CFO-controlled; not an incentive pool	**₩1.0bn**
Maximum gross spend	**₩8.0bn**

No H2 breakeven claim. Base volume test: 2m incremental rides. Funding buys service proof, not market share at any cost.

Gated execution calendar

JUN–JUL

Readiness / existing team budget

Freeze baseline; sign licence, Korean UX and roster gates.

AUG–SEP

Tranche 1 / up to ₩2bn

Two cells; +1,500 WAD; ≥80% matches; ≥30% D30 repeat.

OCT–NOV

Tranche 2 / up to ₩3bn

Four-week service gate + validated monetization contracts; add cells only if both pass.

DECEMBER

Tranche 3 / up to ₩3bn

+3,000 WAD; ≥85% matches; ≥40% D30 repeat; mature-cohort contribution ≥0.

STOP RULE: miss gates → no next tranche; repair existing cells.
Critical legal or safety failure → suspend the affected service immediately.

All spend and performance metrics are planning assumptions. Envelope: August–December, net of VAT; excludes existing run-rate cost.

Build a durable #2 through reliability, not discounts

Use the rebrand to promise a locally dependable service. Invest in capabilities that lower empty time, protect earnings and monetize trust.

H2 2024

Instrument the operating core

- Forecast peaks using own demand, weather and event signals; recommend repositioning without unsafe driving pressure.
- Track pickup reliability, driver net ₩/hour and fair dispatch by cell. Use holdouts for every major experiment.
- Build recurring business demand and reservation operations before making premium service promises.

2025

Monetize trust; pilot cleaner supply

- Test a B2B expense portal and lawful reservation fees. Net revenue must cover variable service cost.
- Pilot 100 EV taxis with fleets and charging partners; confirm subsidy and municipal eligibility first. [10]
- Compare EV vs LPG on matched shifts: driver earnings, cost/km, charging downtime and lifecycle emissions.

2026+

Replicate only proven economics

- Expand city by city only after local supply, permits, full-fare repeat and contribution gates pass.
- Scale EV support only if earnings and pickup availability hold; disclose electricity mix, empty km and charging losses.
- Build partner booking APIs and service-led loyalty. Defer autonomous/private-car bets until legal and economic proof.

THE #2 TEST

By end-2025: #2 on independent rider-app MAU for three consecutive months.

Validate with repeat riders, active supply and independent trip estimates—not installs. Continue investment only where mature cohorts earn positive contribution.

[6,8,10] Legal, data and EV policy context. 2025+ initiatives are hypotheses requiring separate pilot budgets and approval.

Q&A

01 Do we agree to win two dense Seoul beachheads before pursuing national reach?

02 Will we authorize ₩2bn for launch—and enforce the gates before committing the remaining ₩6bn?

03 Who owns weekly intervention across supply, Korean product, compliance and contribution?

Recommendation: approve preparation and tranche 1 only; return with verified baselines and signed launch gates.

Historical evidence: what it says—and what it does not

Offline synthesis: no live retrieval was possible. URLs are publisher locators; verify archived releases and tables dated ≤31 May 2024.

PUBLIC REFERENCE / AS-OF	FACT OR DATA REQUEST	INTERPRETATION / LIMIT
[1] KFTC / February 2023	Kakao T app-call dominance ≈90%+ in 2021; unfair dispatch case against Kakao Mobility.	Supports network-effect and fair-dispatch thesis. Not a measured May 2024 share. KFTC English releases — 14 February 2023
[2] Taxi associations / fleet series	Order of magnitude: ≈250,000 licensed taxis nationally. Rounded working estimate; snapshot not retrieved.	Do not size active supply from fleet count. Obtain corporate / independent and regional breakdowns. Korea National Joint Conference of Taxi Associations
[3] KOTSA / safety and driver data	Use taxi driver age, qualification and safety tables. No driver-age percentage is asserted in this deck.	Pull latest pre-cut-off tables and pair with fleet rosters / shift availability. Certificates ≠ active shifts. Korea Transportation Safety Authority / TMACS
[4] KTO / 2019 and 2023 arrivals	2019: 17,502,756; 2023: 11,031,665 international arrivals. 2023 / 2019 = 63.0%.	Supports hotel / visitor wedge. Tourist arrivals are not unique ride-hailing users or a taxi TAM. Korea Tourism Data Lab — inbound visitor statistics
[5] Seoul / fare schedules	Standard base fare ₩4,800 from 1 February 2023 vs ₩3,800; late-night peak surcharge up to 40%.	Higher ticket raises service expectations. Night rates vary by time band; use current authorized tariff tables. Seoul Metropolitan Government — taxi fare notices

Source-quality note: [1,4,5] recalled historical facts; [2] directional estimate; [3] required dataset, not a quantified finding.

Close the evidence gaps before releasing scale capital

Named public sources inform the strategic design. Legal applicability, registrations and source versions require local confirmation.

[6] Passenger Transport Service Act

Platform framework: transport (Type 1), franchise (Type 2), brokerage (Type 3). Counsel to confirm the actual entity's registrations, fees and franchise path.

Official Korean Law Information Center

[7] MOLIT / October 2022 measures

Late-night taxi shortage response supports focus on productive driver hours, not headline vehicle registrations. Refresh shift economics after fare changes.

Ministry of Land, Infrastructure and Transport

[8] PIPA + location information

Confirm privacy notices, transfer basis, retention, processor controls and location-service obligations with counsel; no blanket data-localization claim is assumed.

Personal Information Protection Commission / law portal

[9] Rebrand market analogue

UT's public rebrand to Uber Taxi in March 2024 is a challenger precedent only. It is not proof of SuperK-T ownership, assets, distribution or present market share.

Uber Newsroom — Korea / UT corporate releases

[10] EV policy / February 2024

2024 Ministry of Environment subsidy guidelines: check taxi eligibility and municipal budgets before contracting. No subsidy value is built into the economics.

Ministry of Environment — 2024 EV subsidies

REQUIRED INTERNAL DATA / by July

May baseline by cell: requests, matches, completed trips, driver shifts, cancellation, fare, revenue, variable cost and cohort repeat. Reconcile to ledger and external MAU panel.

Owner: Strategy + Finance + Operations

Underwrite a learning investment—not a breakeven forecast

All values below are illustrative assumptions. Incremental rides and driver activity must be validated against holdout cells and the May baseline.

BASE VOLUME TEST — **2,000 average incremental WAD × 50 trips/week × 20 weeks = 2.0m trips × ₩14,000 = ₩28bn gross bookings**

Unit economics / completed trip

Effective net revenue yield	0%	2%	4%
Platform revenue	₩0	₩280	₩560
Cash variable service cost	₩300	₩300	₩300
Contribution before incentives	**–₩300**	**–₩20**	**₩260**

At the 4% monetized-mix test

Revenue ₩1.12bn; gross spend ceiling ₩8.00bn;
net investment ≈₩6.88bn before VAT, settlement float
and existing run-rate costs. Treasury must fund float separately.

At 0% yield, the net investment ceiling is ₩8bn.
4% is unproven—not an assumed fee on all basic taxi trips.

Volume downside / fixed-envelope exposure

Case	Low	Base	High
Average incremental WAD	1,200	2,000	2,500
Trips / driver / week	35	50	60
Incremental rides (20 weeks)	0.84m	2.00m	3.00m
₩8bn gross spend / ride	**₩9,524**	**₩4,000**	**₩2,667**

Illustration: 25% mix × ₩1,800 lawful net fee = ₩450 / ride; not contracted.

MATURE-COHORT RELEASE GATE

Require revenue ≥₩450, cost ≤₩300 and ongoing
incentive ≤₩150 per trip: contribution ≥0.
Test four weeks on rider cohorts ≥8 weeks old;
exclude acquisition / step-fixed cost, not support.

₩ = KRW. Platform revenue is not metered fare. Ordinary zero-commission brokerage may yield 0%; lawful monetization must be proven.

A single scorecard, with definitions Finance can audit

Weekly CEO review; daily cell-level control room. Strategy owns definitions; CFO signs incremental spend and contribution calculations.

Incremental weekly active drivers	Verified drivers with ≥10 completed SuperK-T trips/week; count above the frozen May baseline, net of displacement from adjacent cells.
Service quality	Match = accepted within 60 seconds / valid requests. Fulfilment = completed / valid requests; target ≥80%. P90 request-to-pickup ≤8 min on completed trips; report failed requests separately.
Driver retention / earnings	≥65% of a new active cohort remains active in week 4. Report net ₩/online hour after fuel / charging and fees, with and without incentives.
Rider activation / repeat	CAC = acquisition spend / incremental first-trip riders. D30 repeat = ≥1 full-fare repeat on days 8–30; target ≥40%. Use mature cohorts, not partial months.
Mature-cohort contribution	Rider cohorts ≥8 weeks old: net platform revenue − payment / service / support − ongoing driver and rider incentives. Exclude acquisition and step-fixed launch costs only.
National #2 / end-2025	Independent rider-app MAU rank for three months; agree panel / competitors first and disclose Kakao T multi-service bias. MAU ≠ completed taxi-trip share.

CONTROL RULE Randomized cell/time holdouts + six-week cohort reads. No new tranche if service gates fail or mature contribution stays negative. Compliance / safety can halt any launch; CFO owns cash stop; Korea GM owns the recovery plan within seven days.

All thresholds are proposed. Baseline and sample sizes must be signed off in June–July before using targets to release funds.